

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
1	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Does our SLA with R&R include any penalties for failure to reply to messages in agreed time frame?	No.
2	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Can we remove VAT for staff costs and also claim back previous VAT payments?	No. This changed following changes made by HMRC from 1 November 2018. See HMRC website "Revenue and Customs Brief 6 (2018): VAT exemption for all domestic service charges".
3	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Why has the board approved service charge budget increases each year? what specific works were carried out for each plan and how much did they cost?	The Board sets the budget after review the previous expenditure and known future works each year. Whilst these are the planned/expected amounts, the actual expenditure is recorded within the annual accounts, which are published in September each year.
4	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Are there plans to increase the service charge in future?	We would always envisage inflationary pressures, but there are no specific known plans for increases outside of inflation. See FAQ on reserves for the topics being progressed to try and reduce overall charges.
5	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Can the board size be increased to include representatives from each building's block?	Please refer to FAQ on board and GMV structure.
6	Farnsworth Court	Osas	What is the board's plan to increase communication with leaseholders?	Please refer to FAQ on board communications.
7	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Can we remove the cost of maintaining GMV communal areas (e.g. the park) from the SC?	No. As part of our leases, these are areas that we are obliged to maintain.
8	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Why do we need a reserve fund for a car park?	Whilst at a much lower level than for individual blocks there are still elements within the Car Parks that will need funding for renewal, in due course. These include car park gates, lighting, electrical replacements, door entry systems. A small allowance is also made to contribute to the external decorations of the block which the car park forms part of.
9	Farnsworth Court	Osas	Who has been the beneficiary of interest on reserve funds?	Interest on reserve funds is credited to the block which owns the reserves.
10	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	Is there an open tender for the management service, i.e. R&R? (There should be rather we hear the other are as bad and even if we are going to give R&R the contract again?)	Not at present, but this is, of course a major topic for the new Board to consider.
11	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	Do members of GMVML have the power to appoint and remove directors? if so, what is the process?	Please refer to FAQ on board and GMV structure.
12	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	Who are the Directors now and how did they become Director?	Please refer to FAQ on board and GMV structure.
13	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	For GMVML, is there an AGM where members can ask questions with the board?	Please refer to FAQ on board communications.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
14	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	Directors should answer to leaseholders, right? But so far all I hear is, it's out of our control. Can I ask what is in our control?	See FAQ on board and GMV structure. The Board is responsible for the maintenance and upkeep of the common parts of the village, appointment of the managing agent and the setting of Service Charge and Reserve levels. There are a small number of important topics that the Board is not able to control: Insurance (Aviva), Hot Water and Heating (Switch2, on behalf of the Developer, GMVL) and the maintenance of Southern Park (The Land Trust) although we do contribute to the maintenance of this and can liaise/escalate topics, as required.
15	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	Why do we need uniform for staff? I get some might need safety gears/clothing, but 10k a year? Who provide the uniform?	The actual spend category is for staff uniform and PPE (which includes safety gear, mask, gloves, etc.). Spend on this in accounts form 2018-2022 have ranged between £1,754 - £10,260 with an average spend of £5.804. Specifically on the uniforms this is in keeping with sites of our size in London. If the collective view was that it is not required that is fine but given the salary for most concierge and porters is around the London living wage we would not then mandate a smart or professional dress code for them.
16	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	At the time of writing this, there's hot water problem again, I thought the point of Switching to Switch2 and doing all the work was to improve things but I have had more problems the last few months than the entire time Eon was looking after the hot water. I understand it's out of the board control but the board should still engage with Switch2 to try to improve things?	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
17	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	How much reserve fund we have in for the estate and for Newton Lodge? What are the jobs that we are planning to use the reserve fund on?	See FAQ on Reserves
18	Alamaro Lodge	Matt McCabe	When is schedule and scope of works expected for cladding. If difficult to predict then best case / worst case.	Please refer to the FAQ on Cladding.
19	Alamaro Lodge	Matt McCabe	When can we expect a 50% reduction to sc. as part of this when can we expect plan plus timeline to significantly reduce sc. if not 50% what is the prediction.	No specific percentage reduction is defined, our goal remains minimising the service charge and reserves whilst managing the village. It will differ between blocks. The reduction in electricity costs will have a big impact on service charge collections. Reserves specific note covers the key activities to manage down big ticket items in reserves. For Alamaro this will include a revised lift strategy and a review of external redecs cycles taking into account the aluminium windows and the works the developer will commit to this year.
20	Alamaro Lodge	Matt McCabe	Can we get an independant assessor to benchmark sc aginst other developments.	See FAQ on Benchmarking
21	Alamaro Lodge	Matt McCabe	Can we put to tender managing agent to get better quality and value who will help drive down sc which is a key objective for all leaseholders. If so when is earliest this can be done and who will manage?	Yes, this is possible. There needs to be a balance between quality of service and cost effectiveness. Ultimately, this would need to be overseen by the Board, but realistically, a specific procurement consultant would be required to support an exercise of this nature, due to the size and complexity of the contract required.
22	Alamaro Lodge	Matt McCabe	Given the developer has a conflict of interest with selling new builds until 2028 on the peninsula how can the board protect us against unnecessary delays	The fact that the developer continues to build on the newer phases is independent to the cladding remediation works. The Developer has signed a contract with the government to fix life critical issues in our high-rise buildings. As part of that agreement (between the government and Developer) there is an obligation that works shouldn't be delayed any longer than if it was done under the BSF. The Board has already made representations to the Government that the works cannot be completed within the timelines previously committed under the BSF. We await their response for next steps.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
23	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	For a 50% reduction of service charge per block what are the options that board can propose for the leaseholders community to review? Assuming they are the SMEs here. For ex an extreme could by get rid of R&R and community manages the services (not saying it's something would be agrees but atleast give us sense of the impact if we need our sc cost down at any cost).	See FAQ on Reserves and benchmarking
24	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	Before every board meeting can an agenda be circulated in form of emails to lease holders and representatives from block have a say on those?	At present the agenda for Board meetings is not distributed in advance. Additionally, there are no structured 'block representatives'. This is a topic that can be considered as part of the efforts required to enhance communications, which the Board agrees needs to happen. Whilst we have had leaseholder representatives in the past this will be down to continued engagement and commitment from volunteer block representatives.
25	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	Post the meeting can a clear and transparent communication on those agenda be circulated with action items.	The Board minutes are drafted and are reviewed at the next Board meeting for approval. Once approved, the meeting minutes are published on R&R online. We acknowledge that some of the historic meeting minutes were loaded to R&R online but they inadvertently had an expiry date. These have now been corrected so that all minutes should now be available. The board maintain an active action tracker that is reviewed at each meeting.
26	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	If leaseholder miss deadline on service charges can there be auto email & text reminders set and sent every week before handing the case to legal and imposing a high charge to leaseholder?	It is the responsibility of each leaseholder to pay their service charge by the due dates. A first reminder is issued 7 days after the due date, 2nd reminder 14 days after the due date. Referral to external solicitors can be made 7 days after second reminder.
27	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	In case fines are collected by leaseholder for delay can that amount be made transparent on how it's used? Can that amount be credited back to the leaseholder service charge account after deducting the legal fees?	Where cases are referred to solicitors R&R will charge £180 (there is no charge for the first two reminders). Bretherton's (the legal firm) will then take charges for any actions they also take to collect the outstanding amount. This is not income to the service charge account and is to cover their costs for following the process. It is not part of the managing agent fee as it wouldn't be rechargeable to all leaseholders and is a specific cost for chasing delayed payments.
28		Jane	Why is our service charge considerably higher than other comparable developments. The rises have been drastic and with a lack of transparency.	See FAQ on benchmarking
29	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	When did the investigation start November (as per Shakti) or January as (per Adnan & Savvas)?	As the investigation is active it wouldn't be prudent to state anything beyond the updates reviewed and issued. This is to ensure we do not prejudice the investigation or leaseholder recovery.
30	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	What is the scope of investigation (Insurance or OpEx invoices)?	The investigation has a number of different workstreams beyond the topics you have listed. As it is active it wouldn't be prudent to state anything beyond the updates reviewed and issued. This is to ensure we do not prejudice the investigation or leaseholder recovery.
31	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Has GMVML obtained legal help in the investigation and dealing with R&R ?	As the investigation is active it wouldn't be prudent to state anything beyond the updates reviewed and issued. This is to ensure we do not prejudice the investigation or leaseholder recovery. Please revert to updates from R&R or the board. The goal of the investigation is to independently validate any leaseholder losses and maximise restitution / recovery.
32	Why was the R&R not put out to tender before renewal?	Dejan Miladinovic	What is Board's objective in conversations with R&R?	Managing the day-to-day operations of the village.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
33	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Do these conversations, in any way, limit GMVML's future options (not limited to legal) ?	No actions have been taken that prejudice or limit future actions. Our limited responses are designed to ensure we do not prejudice our / leaseholders position on this.
34	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Are any R&R staff being investigated? If so, are these individuals still dealing with GMV West?	As the investigation is active it wouldn't be prudent to state anything beyond the updates reviewed and issued. This is to ensure we do not prejudice the investigation or leaseholder recovery.
35	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Did the Board discuss with R&R any settlement with any individuals being investigated?	No.
36	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Was investigation discussed at April Board meeting?	If it was it will be minuted or redacted if this will prejudice the current investigation. The board have held a number of meetings on a weekly basis with R&R to gain updates.
37	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	When did GMVML Board decide to renew R&R contract ?	It has not been renewed for this year. It was last renewed in March 2022.
38	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Was it contract renewal approved via email vote or at the meeting?	It has not been renewed for this year (2023)
39	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Has Board put R&R on notice since?	N/A. The contract has not been renewed so there is no committed length to place on notice.
40	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	When did the Board request the meeting with R&R which took place on Friday May 5th ?	Wednesday 3 May 2023
41	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	How has the Board managed 'conflict of interest' by onsite staff?	R&R as our appointed managing agents provide all HR functions including managing conflicts of interest. Where an issue is flagged directly to the board we would raise this at the appropriate level with R&R to investigate. The board itself maintains a register of interests for board members that is updated at least annually.
42	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	How has the Board overseen contract selection?	R&R as our appointed managing agents perform most procurement activities for tenders of onsite services such as gardening, electrical works, lift maintenance, etc. We have provided input into specific items around fire safety reviews, appointing contract administrators for major works, surveyors for CapEx reports, etc. For major works items, which are subject to section 20 consultations, there is also an opportunity provided for leaseholders to propose contractors who should be considered for works.
43	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Can the Board share any and all advices received by the Board in the past 10 years on retendering managing agent contract?	No, as the advice was provided on the basis that it was confidential to the Board. But see FAQ on Benchmarking.
44			Can we look at reducing the frequency of cleaning of common areas by half if that help reduce some of the staff cost significantly	Reducing the frequency of cleaning is not a topic that is being actively considered at present. Focus is being applied to increasing the effectiveness of the cleaning schedule so that we get value for money, rather than cutting it down.
45	Alamara Lodge		The managment charges are far too high in relation to the overall service. R&R directors were paid £2.5m based on the FY21 accounts based on the Companies House website.	See FAQs on Reserves and Benchmarking

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
46		Danny	The Standing Charge for the new Switch2 CHP service is £1.20 per day, so a total of £438pa. The previous service was £55/qtr, why is there such a huge difference. On the Switch2 website (this maybe pertinent for this complex - I cannot say) they state: "Standing charges can cover the administration, billing and maintenance of the heat network you live on. Standing charges are scheme specific and are set by the landlord or heat supplier. Switch2 are not responsible for setting your standing charges and are unable to change these." Why is there such a big increase in this cost, who is receiving this increase?	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
47	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	the Windows at Newton Lodge are all not aluminium?	No, not aluminium. Most blocks (except Alamaro, Faraday and Maurer) have external wooden window frames. Specifically for Newton some of the windows in the pods at the top appear to be aluminium the rest are wooden windows from a company called Rationale.
48	Metcalfe Court		Why arent we having the daily service charge for Switch2 being reduced if they are consistently with maintenance and stopping the service therefore not providing a service?	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
49	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	When did the board disuss collecting less than a fully amortised reserves amount, as implied by Shakti in the group chat? please share some proof and considerations at the time.	There have been many discussions around the options that might be progressed for reserves. Whilst this might have been a topic discussed as one of those discussion, it is not one that has currently been progressed. Unable to identify the dates of the multiple discussions specifically.
50	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	When did the board instruct PJ Harte in 2019 ?	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019. Document requests also raised via R&R online which have been responded to.
51	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	When did the contract with PJ Harte for 2019 external redecorations come into force ?	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019
52	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share the copy of the PJ Harte contract	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019. Document requests also raised via R&R online which have been responded to.
53	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Has board considered reaching out to leaseholders for ideas on savings prior to 2023/2024 budget? If so, why it hasn't happened ?	Please refer to FAQ on board communications.
54	Not specified		The community heating bills are unreasonably high compared to similar estates, and even much higher than my nearby apartment without community heating. The bill needs to be significantly reduced for comunity heating to be meaningful at all, otherwise, why not abolish that.	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
55	Kilby Court	Adam Turner	Services charges are unacceptably high. Nearly £4,000 p.a. for a one-bedroom apartment. This level makes the apartment unsaleable, especially in a higher interest rate environment. Typical levels for TWO-bedroom apartment in London, including a gym and with EWS works complete, is £2,000 p.a. Service charges need to be LESS THAN HALF THE CURRENT LEVEL. How do we achieve this?	See FAQ on benchmarking
56	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	Can accountability and boundaries of autonomy be set for the directors? ex: For any decision impacting the financial status quo for leaseholders board should not be able to signoff unless certain protocol to get leaseholder approval is followed	The Board is ultimately responsible for all decision making within GMV West. It would not be practical or timely to seek a consensus across a village with 1.108 units as there will always be diverse views and motivations. Formal consultations ('Section 20' process) are mandatory for one-off spend where the cost to any individual leaseholder exceeds £250. See FAQs around 'Board Communications' and 'Reserves'.
57	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	How can our cladding solution time-lines be agree and created? this is a massive uncertainty and we need lobbying power in some of our representatives to help with this.	Please refer to the FAQ on Cladding.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
58	Metcalfe Court	Zoe Frantzi	The standing charge for Switch2 has tripled compared to what we were paying before with EON. Why have we gone with a provider charging so much more expensive? Was the board aware of the pricing? Was this the most competitive offer we received? And if this is because of the maintainability of the system, why are leaseholders burdened by paying for the deficiencies of a system that Taylor Wimpey should have been responsible for? My understanding is that developer always has known the issues since the block was built and were never willing to spend a penny to fix them. Because of this, the GMV Managing Company (GMVML) never agreed to take ownership of the energy center, and that's why this is still owned by the developer (Taylor Wimpey). And it seems they found a way to pass on the costs of fixing the energy center to the leaseholders.	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
59	Metcalfe Court	Zoe Frantzi	Regarding communal electricity, we understand there has been a significant increase in electricity usage in 2023. However, we have noticed people abusing communal electricity for their personal needs i.e charging electric cars. Has this ever been raised and taken into consideration? Also, what is actually included in communal electricity i.e. is Conceirge electricity equally distributed amongst all leasholder?	R&R update - We have had a few complaints in the past and we instructed electricians to switch off the supply to those plugs and we can do that for additional ones after reviewing the approach with the board. If there is a concern on a specific plug please raise with the village manage who will investigate isolating it from unauthorised use or switching it off.
60	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please explain the process for appointing R&R to manage electricity procurement? When did GMVML ever use other brokers ?	The board instruct R&R as our managing agents to tender most core services including electricity procurement. This was brought in house to R&R utilities in 2021 - prior to that, fairnet was used as the electricity broker. For 2023, the board has approached three independent brokers to test the market and the process to select a supplier is ongoing.
61	Maurer Court	Julien	Is the level of maintenance of the garden needed? Can we reduce the level of some of the activies (such as cutting the grass) in order to reduce costs	We are currently seeking tenders for the gardening contract to validate value for money as well as seeking the views of other contractors on the maintenance regime that we need to maintain the communal gardens at a good standard.
62	Maurer Court	Julien	Regarding the lighting, what is a legal requirement (parking?) and what is something we can adjust. Can we add some timers in the building entrance? Can we cut the light in the garden past a specific hour (everyone got a torch with their phone nowadays)?	R&R response: There should always be adequate lighting in the common areas including car parks. Some of the blocks have the lights on timers and some don't because of the way the lights are wired. Some blocks have sensors however if one sensor goes then all lights stay on until we can pin point the faulty light and fix this. For example, car parks are on all the time because of the wiring - it would be a very costly project to change the design however if GMVML would like this to happen we can look into it. Regarding cutting lights out in the gardens - whilst we understand the need to save money, we do not believe that majority of the leaseholders would agree to cut the lights out for the night however this is a decision for impacted leaseholders and the board.
63	Maurer Court	Julien	Does R&R have any incentive to see any cost going up? Can we remove those incentives from the contracts if there is any?	No, to the contrary there is an incentive payment available if R&R were to propose a cost saving initiative. No such proposals have been forthcoming recently. .
64	Metcalfe Court	Zoe Frantzi	What exactly is included in general & ground maintenance? Car park & common areas filthy which doesn't reflect the projected amount (~166k)	General maintenance is used for any repairs that may be needed throughout the year and grounds maintenance relates to gardening. The grounds budget does not cover cleaning of the car park or common areas as these are managed by the onsite porters. All blocks are currently being subjected to a more extensive deep clean, once these are finished, the same will be completed of the four Car Parks.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
65	Maurer Court	Julien	When a resident leaves a large object in the bin locker (which it should not have done), I believe we have to use service charge money to get those objects disposed of. How much are we paying on that? Is it possible to "organise" that, with a specific place for disposing large objects and a regular schedule for the removing of those items. Organizing that might make it more predicatble and less costly	Where residents have left bulk waste in any of the bin stores or estate the porters will collect them and try and dispose of them in bins or recycle. Where this isn't possible regular collections are organised with a commercial bulk waste firm. R&R issue periodic reminders to residents to arrange disposal through the council or another source. Where it is possible to attribute disposal to a resident/Leaseholder they will be charged for this. Bulk waste disposal at a council recycling facility is free for domestic users and a collection can be arranged with the council for a nominal fee. As per the accounts the bulk waste disposal costs were as follows:- 2021/22 £9,000 2020/21 £7,590 2019/20 £8,768 2018/19 £10,118
66	Farnsworth Court	Shuopeng	What was the basis on the decision to transition to Switch 2.	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
67	Maurer Court	Julien	Is it possible to have more tranparency regarding invoices paid for purchases done by R&R that are under the thresheold where board approval is necessary (such as having all those invoices available to all leaseholders). This would allow scrutiny and challenges. And would ensure that we get the best value for our money.	The Board does not approve invoices. This is the task that the Managing Agent has been engaged for and is part of the management fee. Leaseholders are entitled to request visibility of any invoices for the financial year within the six months following the publication of the annual audited accounts. There has been a suggestion to form an audit sub-committee that performs some sample checks. This is something the board would fully support.
68	Maurer Court	Julien	As an element that is taken into account for the insurance annual cost is the number of claims and their amounts, how can we ensure that works done after a claim is made are appropriate and not inflated in scope or cost?	As you note claims history is an element of the price increase along with reinstatement value increases and risk factors such as cladding. Aviva appear to place their entire portfolio up together so claims history is likely normalised across a much larger pool. We benefited from this when there was an expensive fire in Metcalfe but in certain years may subsidise other schemes. Insurance is an element controlled by Aviva and they are increasingly sending loss adjusters to review the claim and assign a value against their matrix before approving it. R&R do support elements of claim management on our behalf by liaising with Aviva. They have introduced improvements to the process to ensure there is clear communication that leaseholders can nominate their own contractors, they will also check with leaseholders to confirm works are completed before passing on this confirmation to Aviva so the contractors are paid.
69	Maurer Court	Julien	Could we have an updated plan for the Service Charges that would cover the curent level of reserves, the expected service charges and the expected works that the service charges are due to cover? Can we have the hypothesis that are underlying that plan (such as cladding remediation cost coverage by the developper, maintenance cycle duration, elevator maintenance option)? If there is a high level of uncertainty on a specific hypothesis, can we have the worst case & expected case scenarios?	See various FAQs on reserves, cladding and benchmarking.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
70	Maurer Court	Julien	What's the operational steps that needs to happen to change the lease to reduce the maintenance cycle from 7 to 20 years for the buildings with aluminium window frames? What are the risk that would make that change fail and how do we manage that?	The Maurer external redecoration cycle (and those for the majority of blocks, except Moseley) was extended from 7 to 10 years following leaseholder consultations in 2017. The Board has, however commissioned Chartered Surveyors to review again to assess what can be done to further extend the cycles. This will consider the beneficial cost implications, together with the risks, additional maintenance requirements that will be incurred as well as any compromises that leaseholders will need to consider. Once these have been prepared, it is likely that this will require leaseholder consultation to determine what options Leaseholders are prepared to accept.
71	New Becquerel Court		If an error by staff results in charges being incurred, is there a route for us to receive compensation? For example, if my spare key is temporarily lost by the concierge, my cleaner cannot get in, and I have to pay them, can I receive compensation for this?	R&R Update - If a mistake happens due to staff error we would fully investigate the issue and yes, compensation would be potentially possible should we prove that one of the members made a mistake and that resulted in someone being charged for that mistake. It would depend on the type of error, etc.
72	Maurer Court	Julien	What are the key contractors that we are working with? What are the kind of work they do for us? Could we have a in-house ressource that could to that same work in a most cost-effective way? (Handiman, gardener, plumber, electrician, etc.)	There are a range of services and contractors working onsite. These range from those providing services a few times a day (or full-time) to those that come in occasionally when needed. Likewise the work ranges from broad skills such as plumber, gardeners, Handymen, electricians, etc. to very specialist skills around lift maintenance, fire alarm servicing, etc. Some of the broad skills have previously been in house. We have specifically asked R&R as part of the budget setting for this year to onboard one or two handymen to do odd jobs and cover internal decorations. They have struggled to find individuals at the salary level being offered and the search continues. As a principle we can look at this for other categories where there is enough ongoing work to support a full time resource. Gardening as an example could move to a hybrid model with a full time gardener and some contractor support. For electricians we would need to ensure they cover all the core skills we need and of course we would be responsible for ongoing training, certification, etc. This needs to be balanced against the cost of using an external firm.
73	New Becquerel Court	Sean	How much does running a 24 hour concierge cost? If we reduced this to 16 hours (0600-2200?), what would the cost saving be?	The provision of a 24x7 concierge service is mandated by one of the lease provisions, so we are unable to reduce these hours. The staffing level was, however, reduced to just one person to bring the cost down as far as we are able.
74	Faraday Lodge	Alex & Mark	Is a service charge expert employed to scrutinise these charges and to negotiate a reduction - companies do this on a no reduction no fee basis. Why is the management charge so high.	Refer to the FAQ on benchmarking. Please note the updates that are coming through from R&R and the board on upcoming actions related to some of the topics you have raised.
75	Da Vinci Lodge		Why is the standing charge for the Switch 2 so high? Is this going to be discussed and changed? Is there a different standing charge depending on the m2 of the apartments? Why Switch 2 are charging for daily service on the days when they are not providing a service or their services are interrupted (for example today)?	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
76	Maurer Court		What is board doing to reduce service charges. Apparently this is becoming a real issue in selling GMV flats.	See FAQ on Reserves
77	Maurer Court		We appreciate that you have secured 6 mortgage companies to provide affordable mortgage re cladding issue but apparently it is difficult to secure services of solicitors. Is there any assistance from the Board re selling?	The Board cannot specifically assist with any sales/conveyancing issues. Where, however, mortgage companies or solicitors have specific questions relating to the village or in particular relating to the fire safety/cladding issues, then we have been able to support these in some instances. Please reach out to R&R or the Village Manager in the first instance to consider what information can be provided to support.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
78	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	When did GMVML issue a request for quotes for external redecorations in 2019 ?	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019
79	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	What is the exact date of Notice of Intention (November) cited in Notice of Estimates for external works?	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019
80	Becquerel Court High		The block entrance doors, especially 25-40, are in very poor condition for many years. When will they be replaced with the metal frame doors similar to Farnworth Court doors?	Upgrade to the external entrance doors has been budgeted for in the years of 2024/25 and 2025/26 - these have been pushed out a few times. Installation of the new doors in Farnsworth was a trial which we believe was successful and would have been rolled out to other blocks. However, given the uncertainty around cladding and what costs may have fallen to leaseholders the board suspended all planned spend from the reserves unless it was essential (a failed fire panel, water pump, etc.). A number of blocks have required works such as the door replacements you have highlighted. Now that there is some certainty that the developer will fund external works these item will be looked at again with the impacted blocks and agree if these should be taken forward with a contractor to expedite the works.
81	Becquerel Court High		There are multiple water leaks after the rain in Moseley row car park that can damage cars. What are the plans to fix this?	R&R response - We assume this mainly relates to the second floor of the car park as that seems to have the most signs of historic leaks. We have spoken with the surveyor that oversaw the works to the car park back in 2019 and they have advised there were leaks in the car park due to the movement joint and a gutter was subsequently installed to divert the water - this gutter did not run the entire length as it was not leaking at one end. The surveyor doesn't believe that the actual surface of the car park is defective as that was looked at previously under warranty. The surveyors are due to visit GMV in the coming weeks and they will assess the car park although it will be more difficult if we don't get any rain. We have also sent them pictures of some of the areas that we believe they should look at when they come to inspect. In the interim, if anyone sees any leaks, please report them to the village manager as soon as possible specifying the location so that we can record this. If identified immediately during or after rainfall, photographs would be helpful to assist any further investigation.
82	Becquerel Court High		What are the plans to install the new brise soleil panels?	No specific plans at this stage. Whilst some investigation and high level costs have been obtained any major work of this nature was put on hold until the cladding issues had been resolved. It is likely that this will be a significant cost so will need to be considered with alternatives and in line with the other works on the blocks.
83	Becquerel Court High		Some communal areas of the block are poorly maintained and need redecoration. Why are they not maintained to a good standard?	Given the uncertainty around cladding and what costs may be due to fall to leaseholders the board suspended all planned spend from the reserves unless it was essential (e.g. a failed fire panel, water pump, etc.). A number of blocks are due for internal redecorations. Now that there is some certainty that the developer will fund external works these item will be looked at again. The board has asked R&R to investigate the feasibility and cost implications of hiring a full time decorator to work across the blocks. Alternatively we will review essential decoration items with the impacted blocks and agree if these should be taken forward with a contractor to expedite the works.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
84	Becquerel Court High		We have been collecting the reserves to replace our lifts. The condition of the lift in 25-40 block is poor. I noticed that many bolts are missing from the control panel. What are the plans to provide a proper servicing and eventually replace them? If there is an alternative replacement cycle, when will I see the reduction of the reserves collection to reflect that?	See FAQ on reserves. We do have a comprehensive maintenance contract in place that should be maintaining lifts to a good standard. Once lifts start to become unreliable and parts are no longer available for repairs to be completed without costs to leaseholders, this is likely to be the time to initiate the lift upgrade programme. The Board would not want to spend leaseholder money on such a major item until/unless it becomes necessary to do so. We monitor breakdown figures and have commissioned additional condition reports. We will specifically pick this up for your lift to ensure the items you have flagged are picked up by the maintenance contractor to extend the life of the current lift.
85	Farnsworth Court	Alberto	The leaseholder agreement describes the legal obligations and rights we have. Among these rights, we have the right to have the common area of our property clean, safe and well maintained. Even paying an extortionate "Service Charge" on time, our rights were violated with a terrible cleaning service, little or no maintenance of the common areas and no security, with the front door constantly malfunctioning and regularly left open, allowing the entry of strangers and endangering the physical and mental integrity of all residents. Based on these factors, the Leaseholder agreement was legally breached, not allowing R & R to continue as a provider of these services. How do you intend to resolve this case in a short time, before the Leaseholders decide to take a legal action?	We do not consider that any 'leaseholder agreement was legally breached'. We do, however, acknowledge that the level of scrutiny and quality over some of the operational aspects of the village has not been sufficiently robust in recent times. The Board had placed reliance on the updates and assurances provided by R&R and the Village Management, including that weekly site inspections were being completed by the Village Manager. It is apparent that this was either not happening or not happening to a robust standard. As part of issues currently being investigated reinforcements have been provided by R&R to bolster the support for the site team. Greater supervision has been deployed to support the site porters, who are responsible for the cleaning. If there is still an ongoing issue with the front door please do raise this with the new village manager or on R&R online as a fault.
86	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share the written assurances into conflict of interest, as it relates to Bill and the contractors, provided by R&R in the past	Please refer to the published board minutes for 13 December 2016 (published on R&R Online). Details of R&R's investigation into a link between the village manager and a contractor are minuted there.
87	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share all explanatory notes regarding the electricity procurement sent by R&R	See FAQ on electricity.
88	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share the Notice of Intention for external redecoration from Nov 2018	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019. Document requests also raised via R&R online which have been responded to.
89	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share any advice received from consultants in 2020 with regards to external redecoration questions posed by the leaseholders.	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019. Note the timeline, not 2020.
90	Farnsworth Court	Alberto	The value of the Service Charge is scandalous when analyzing the state of the common areas of the Farnsworth Court, the services provided and the annual balance sheet presented by the current administrator. Would you support an audit carried out by the Leaseholders?	We would fully support a review by leaseholders. Any leaseholder can request a full set of invoices under section 22 following the publication of formal annual accounts. This typically occurs in September each year.
91	Farnsworth Court	Alberto	Communication between R & R, GMV management and Leaseholders is almost non-existent if you are not part of the Board. How do you plan to make this communication more fluent and effective, demonstrating professionalism, consideration and respect with the Leaseholders?	Please refer to FAQ on board communications.
92	Maurer Court	Jane	My s/c is currently an eye watering £10700 pa 2-bed flat and tandem car park space in Maurer Court. 60% of my Maurer Court Block service charge is reserves collection! - yet we have some Government BSF funding, developer pledge for cladding, and aluminium windows and a potential longer redecoration cycle to 10-20 years - so what is it being collected for? and why at such a high level? There is now over £1.1 million reserves in the pot for MCourt and with no transparency for its use. In the circumstances can the collection of reserves for Maurer Court be stopped immediately?	See note - reserves. The latest published reserves plan (for Maurer and all other blocks), listing all of the items covered under the CapEx programme, remains available on R&R online as part of the Service Charge pack issued for the 2020/2021 financial years.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
93	Maurer Court	jane	The residents meeting that was called on Thursday 23rd Feb was cancelled with no notice. In that week Metcalfe court were living for a 3rd week without a lift, and hadn't had hot water for a week. This led to all sorts of problems with daily living (taking out the rubbish, bringing in the shopping, ensuring pets were walked, that people could get to work/school clean and on time). In addition it made having a normal (social) life next to impossible and people were confined to their flats, which led to a sense of isolation and helplessness. Communication from the board was minimal and R&R staff were understandably stressed and defensive when challenged. Is there a plan in place that is communicated to residents to ensure that the lift is serviceable and fixed in a timely fashion? In April the rents increased by over £200, with £180 for service charge. There was no warning or consultation and some households were left with the knowledge that they were unable to meet these demands (alongside the rise in heating costs for switch 2 by a third). Mortgages are also substantially higher. This combination will lead to unsustainable hardship, rent arrears, and possible future evictions and residents need to be consulted about how these matters impact on them and how they can be better managed.	The residents meetings are run by the GMVRA (Residents association). We were also advised of the cancellation quite late. Please do see the separate note on Switch 2. All the lifts across GMV are now 15-20 years old. Whilst they are still under support with parts included in the contract some specialist parts are on long lead times. We continue to monitor this and have purchased some items such as lift drives to keep them in stock.
94	New Becquerel Court		It's now fairly obvious that high SC levels leads to a form of 'financial entrapment' ie an inability to sell your flat and move out. What specifically is the Board doing to radically reduce SC levels to market-acceptable figures and/or undertake an overhaul of the SC funding structure / methodology to remedy this ?	See FAQs on reserves and benchmarking.
95	New Becquerel Court		With SC levels forecast to rise to quite scary figures in the coming years, how does the Board see owner leaseholders not being 'SC prisoners' (if we are not already there) with no ability to exit the village ? How does the Board see this predicament being resolved / avoided ?	See FAQs on reserves, cladding and benchmarking.
96	New Becquerel Court		If the Res Fund / SC Fund is now underfunded should it not merely be topped up by a one-off request in order to resolve the excessive SC levels situation? Also where is the rationale in pursuing a financial construct that will doubtless lead to the destruction of property values ?	See FAQ on Reserves. In addition, the reserves collection profile is designed so that leaseholders all pay a fair share of the maintenance to their block and estate during the period of their ownership and to reduce the risk of large one-off bills being issued. The way to reduce overall bills is to find opportunities to reduce the costs within those plans, which is covered in the reserves note.
97	Moseley Row	David Priddle	How have the building insurance costs been apportioned between the Moseley Row residential units, Moseley Row car park and the Switch 2 Office (at the end of Moseley Row) which are all part of the same building? Moseley Row leaseholders have queried this with R&R (Greta), but are yet to receive an answer.	The division of the insurance premium between Moseley Row houses and the car park reflects the figures provided by the surveyors who valued the properties in 2022. The value of the houses now represents 47% of the total value of the block. For the 2022 valuations the surveyors provided separate valuations for the houses and the car park. previously the division of the insurance premium between the houses and car park was based on historical proportions. In the previous figures the houses represented only about 29% of the total value of the block. That is why there was a significant increase in the insurance premium for the houses in 2022-23. We believe the historical division of the value of the block had become out of date over time. We are reviewing how the value of the CHP building is taken into account.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
98	Moseley Row	Carl Smeaton	How has the cost of window cleaning been apportioned between Moseley Row houses and the Moseley Row Car Park and CHP Building? Previous budgets and accounts have had the proportion paid by the car park as very low despite the large amount of glass at the pedestrian entrance that is cleaned inside and out.. This has been queried with R&R (both Greta and Bill) for quite a while with no answer.	"R&R update - After further investigation, it has been confirmed that the CHP building was never part of the scope. The incoming contractor has confirmed that the specification given to him by the site staff did not include the chp unit. With regards to the car park and Moseley row, looking at the historic price schedules, a bigger amount was always associated with the houses and not the car park. If it is believed that this is wrong, we will need approval from the board to make the changes and a decision on what would be fair and reasonable. Also, see tab 'window cleaning' on the supporting spreadsheet - this was prepared in 2017 by the previous Property Manager which is based on historic splits. Board response - We will ask R&R to revisit the split between car parks and houses. If there is a clear issue this will be fixed retrospectively as well.
99	New Becquerel Court		Part of the SC level problem is a result of the decision to lump unprovided for major Capital expenditure (Algae issue costs) on to SC budgets. This all seems to have been a false economy as it has pushed up SC to market-averse levels, sees leaseholders now trapped by not being able to sell their flats and property values diminished. If things are left as they are these aspects will only get worse. What does the Board propose to rectify this situation (or as a minimum open up the conversation in an effort to find an acceptable solution) ?	See FAQs on reserves, cladding and benchmarking. I assume the algae you are referring to is on the render on the block
100	New Becquerel Court		Does the Board take 'ability to sell' into account in their assessment of SC levels as these aspects are intrinsically linked - if not, why not?	No. The Board has the responsibility for maintaining the common areas of the GMV West estate. Whilst this should be in the most cost efficient manner, it won't be done specifically with sales processes in mind. If the buildings are not maintained this will also impact the ability to sell and medium term costs.
101	Alamaro Lodge		I bought off plan in 2000 and the marketing strategy was that the development was affordable living in the heart of extended London. What has happened to the affordability element?	See FAQ on reserves. Unfortunately the marketing strategy from developers rarely meets the reality on the ground. The board's goal remains to sustainably reduce service charges with the reserves being a large part of this. Across the estate the expectation is that electricity costs that went up tremendously last year will now fall back to almost one-third of last year's prices. For Alamaro specifically there are also lift upgrade strategies and a review of external works that should lead to a reduction in reserve demands.
102	Alamaro Lodge		Why is VAT charged on staff costs?	There was previously an agreement that this did not need to be charged. This changed following changes made by HMRC from 1 November 2018. See HMRC website "Revenue and Customs Brief 6 (2018): VAT exemption for all domestic service charges".
103	Alamaro Lodge		Why is the annual service charge so high?	See FAQs on Benchmarking and Reserves.
104	Alamaro Lodge		From where I stand the R&R are an excessive part of the service charge. What can be done about this?	In reality, for a site of this size, it would not be practical to self-manage or run the development without professional Managing Agent support. See FAQs on Benchmarking.
105	Alamaro Lodge		Are the housing association properties paying the same level of service charges?	Yes, all MOAT properties pay the same service charge. It is for MOAT as a housing provider to decide if they then re-charge this to their tenants.
106	Alamaro Lodge		Do all the properties on GMV contribute to the cost of maintaining the communal areas?	Yes. All properties in GMV West contribute to maintaining general communal areas such as roads and the Village Square. All the properties in a particular block contribute to the communal areas in that block

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
107	Alamaro Lodge		What is the current level of reserve funds held for Alamaro Lodge, if less than total reserve funds paid where has the balance been spent?	Please review the FAQ on reserves which includes a breakdown of reserves by block, major spend on external works, upcoming works and lift replacement. Since 2015 the amount spent from reserves on Alamaro was £137,644. The three largest items were - £53,831 for repairs to the wooden cladding and balcony side panel replacement (done via abseiling), £19,496 for fire stopping within riser cupboards (part of this may now be recoverable from the developer under their pledge) and £15,600 for new cold water booster pumps. Other smaller items include fixed wire testing, surveys, EWS surveys, etc. Some of these may now be recoverable from the developer.
108	Alamaro Lodge		Why don't staff wear badges rather than uniform?	The actual spend category is for staff uniform and PPE (which includes safety gear, mask, gloves, etc.). Spend on this in accounts from 2018-2022 have ranged between £1,754 - £10,260 with an average spend of £5.804. Specifically on the uniforms this is in keeping with sites of our size in London. If the collective view was that it is not required that is fine but given the salary for most concierge and porters is around the London living wage we would not then mandate a smart or professional dress code for them.
109	Alamaro Lodge		Why has an independent assessor not been appointed to benchmark service charges against similar developments?	See FAQs on Benchmarking
110	Alamaro Lodge		Why is the number of R&R staff so high? Why do we need staff during the night (why do we need 3 full time over night staff?)	R&R update - We do not have and never had three full time night concierge. The lease requires for the site to have 24/7 concierge. We used to have two day and two night concierges however that was reduced to two day and one night and one part-time concierge. The part-time concierge has now retired and we will not be recruiting a replacement.
111	Alamaro Lodge		Why are the service charges considerably higher than comparable developments? A leaseholder with a mortgage cannot afford this additional extreme cost	See FAQs on Benchmarking
112	Alamaro Lodge		The Landlord's Aviva is grossly deficient, what steps have been taken to rectify this?	The Board of GMVML has no control over the Landlord Aviva (or their agents Mainstay) and we share the frustration of lack of adequate responses to any queries of assistance required.
113	Alamaro Lodge		The high level of Service Charges has made the ownership of properties unsellable. Why has R&R not recognised this and sought to address this problem?	Service Charges are set by the Board of GMVML rather than R&R. See FAQs of Reserves and Benchmarking.
114	Alamaro Lodge		Why was the R&R not put out to tender before renewal?	It hasn't been formally renewed this year.
115	Alamaro Lodge		The new Switch2 standing charge is ~£60 a month even if nothing is used, so an extra £720 per year on top of the current service charge bill. The previous provider was ~£18 per month. Why was a move made to Switch2?	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
116	Maurer Court	Christine A	There has visibly been little to no supervision of and holding to account of contractors to ensure we get value for money from the contracts. What steps will be taken to ensure that moving forward there is much more control over this? e.g. R&R as MA have themselves not been properly held to account and in turn they seem not to have held their staff and the contractors to account. Consequently the cleaning and maintenance services for communal areas, lifts and car parks is appalling and when you complain to village management the attitude is 'it'll do'. The grounds maintenance is equally appalling, the gardeners are seen far less frequently and are not managing the grounds competently - irrigation is not carried out (we kept telling VM that the system wasn't functioning), bushes are left to grow disproportionately high and starve trees of any water there is so consequently trees and bushes have died and are dying. Weeding is not done thoroughly, neither is the cutting back so borders are overgrown and yet the contract price increases year on year. We are now suffering loss of amenity due to neglect	Point noted and accepted. The level of scrutiny and quality over some of the operational aspects of the village has not been sufficiently robust in recent times. The Board had placed reliance on the updates and assurances provided by R&R and the Village Management, including that weekly site inspections were being completed by the Village Manager. It is apparent that this was either not happening or not happening to a robust standard. As part of issues currently being investigated reinforcements have been provided by R&R to bolster the support for the site team. Discussions have been held by senior R&R representatives and the Managing Director of Greenmantle (gardening contractor) in order to remediate the deficiencies in the gardening standards as an example. I believe you have been directly supporting this for your block and have provided invaluable input given your keen interest in gardening. Greater supervision has been deployed to support the site porters, who are responsible for the cleaning. A number of checklists are now in place and the board will continue to sample check as well.
117	Not specified	Christine A	Why were Livlans contracted and allowed to replace paving slabs in Teal Street with concrete which is unsightly and adds to the general dilapidated aspect of the street? This job was clearly beyond the competence of Livlans. The paving slabs should have been replaced like for like. Why is the street never cleaned?	Point noted and accepted. The level of scrutiny and quality over some of the operational aspects of the village has not been sufficiently robust in recent times. The Board had placed reliance on the updates and assurances provided by R&R and the Village Management, including that weekly site inspections were being completed by the Village Manager. It is apparent that this was either not happening or not happening to a robust standard. As part of issues currently being investigated reinforcements have been provided by R&R to bolster the support for the site team. Greater supervision has been deployed to support the site porters, who are responsible for the cleaning. R&R is also specifically reviewing local work carried out in the last few years to confirm if it has been carried out to an appropriate standard, we will ask them to include the slab replacements in this and remediate if they accept it was not the right approach.
118	Not specified	Christine A	We seem to burn electricity as if for fun with lights on in broad daylight and car parks lit 24/7. What plans are there to reduce consumption by converting the village to LED (rather than changing a light bulb when it fails) and installing light sensors so the lights come on when needed. Apparently such measures pay for themselves in approx 3 years	There has been a programme across blocks to replace light fittings with LED ones and the Board were given updates on completion from R&R. R&R are currently validating the progress of this across the site. The Board have also asked them to specifically look at the sensors to see if additional PIR sensors need to be installed in areas that are on for extended periods when they shouldn't be (if this is cost effective to do).
119	Maurer Court	Christine A	Healthy reserves have been accrued for Maurer Court and beyond much needed lift upgrades there are no plans for CapEx. Why therefore are reserve contributions still so high or indeed being levied at all? When I purchased in 2016 my solicitor was informed that reserve contributions would diminish in 2023 once the pot had been replenished	Please see FAQ on reserves. A recent review of lift upgrade options and a potential review of external redecoration plans in conjunction with the works the developer pays for is likely to have a positive impact on reserves collection for your block. Maurer has 7 lifts so any reduction in costs for upgrades will have a big impact.
120	Not specified	Christine A	What income is derived from the Oval Square street traders for the benefit of the village? Where does the money go?	No specific income is currently derived from the Village Square. There is no activity that could be considered as 'Trading', as we are not a trading company, as this may affect the accounting treatment of our accounts.
121	Not specified	Christine A	Who is responsible for the upkeep of the Doctors' surgery? The shutters are hanging off at the rear of the building and there seems to be no attempt to remove or repair them. It looks dreadful and adds to the general air of dilapidation	This would be for the landlord of the Doctors. This is just outside of the perimeter of the GMVML / GMV West estate (the same as the school is also outside our remit).

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
122	Not specified	Christine A	Why are Moat not getting on with finishing the fitting out of 3 Teal Street? There's a housing crisis and yet this large unit has been vacant for a long time and the fitting out works go in fits and starts. A steel security door is still in place. The whole thing is poorly managed and a mess. Why are Moat not held to account to play their part in the upkeep of the area for the benefit of all ?	We have flagged this to MOAT a few times. Their director was onsite the week commencing the 12th of June and is reviewing this with the team to accelerate the fit out and ensure the upkeep of the property is maintained.
123	Not specified	Christine A	Why do we not see evidence of walking the estate and proactive management by R&R PM and village staff? Why are there no walkaround invitations to leaseholders and residents? Why is it left to residents to email or raise tickets when they spot issues which should be spotted by the MA? E.G. cracks appearing in the newly laid MC garden path (under guarantee), lights on in building stairwells and outside entry doors when they should not be, street lights hanging off their supports on MC stairs to podium garden, irrigation not working (ignored for several years), dead trees and vegetation and outdated notices on notice boards. It's all indicative of sloppy management.	Point noted and accepted. The level of scrutiny and quality over some of the operational aspects of the village has not been sufficiently robust in recent times. The Board had placed reliance on the updates and assurances provided by R&R and the Village Management, including that weekly site inspections were being completed by the Village Manager. It is apparent that this was either not happening or not happening to a robust standard. As part of issues currently being investigated reinforcements have been provided by R&R to bolster the support for the site team. Greater supervision has been deployed to support the site porters, who are responsible for the cleaning. Invitations with a timetable have recently been distributed for residents/Leaseholders to join the reinstated block/site walkarounds, which would be an opportunity for individuals to raise any concerns they may have.
124	Edison Court Houses		We paid a lump sum service charge demand of around £9k a few years back, which was on top of our already grossly overcharged monthly SC. Given all that has come to light recently about how badly SC money has been managed, was this lump sum demand justified? Why was it demanded, how was it spent, was it really justifiable, and can it be refunded	The supplementary reserves charges were required to complete the external repair and maintenance of the houses in the 2018/19 financial year as there were insufficient funds available in the reserves to finance the work.
125	Alamara Lodge	Anthea	Can we hire a handyman who reports to us who's KPIs are to increase leaseholder value and improve efficiencies by 1/8/2023	The Board instructed R&R to hire a maintenance person at the start of the year. We have been advised that this has been difficult to fill at the salary being offered. This is, however, still being progressed. We cannot commit to any specific timeline, at this stage.
126	Alamara Lodge	Anthea	Can we hire a full time gardner by 1/8/2023 that reports to us directly who is also responsible for coordinating waste removal by the council	Rather than hiring our own gardener (which would then leave us with absences during annual leave etc) a tender of the gardening contract is in progress to ensure value for money for the service engaged.
127	Alamara Lodge	Anthea	Can we lobby Greenwich Council and Parliment to re-evaluate our obligationss towards public areas not exclusively demised to GMV residents including Oval Square, Lake and Green Spaces and renegotiate terms. We pay so much council tax with all these high rises (compared to areas with terraced houses where teh council is reponsible for street lights). Its unfair for us to light up oval square and streets that are enjoyed by the public. The school children who come from Woolwich and Lewisham occupy our common spaces (Oval Square), vandalize our bus stop and harm our wildlife. They should take responsibility for public spaces.	The Leases we all signed up to stipulate what we need to contribute to, which includes the private land including the Village square, village internal roads and Southern Park (this is managed by the land trust but we contribute to the maintenance). It is highly unlikely that the Royal Borough of Greenwich would adopt land to be maintained at public expense without an obligation for them to do so. This is common with other developments and councils nationally. If this is a topic that many think is worthy of progressing, then perhaps it could be a community led initiative to engage with the authorities.
128	Alamara Lodge	Anthea	Given reduced need for reserves (electricity + cladding) can we stop contributing towards the reserve from 1/9/2023?	No. Electricity is a Service Charge item rather than reserves. See FAQ on reserves for information on approach and forthcoming activity.
129	Alamara Lodge	Anthea	Assuming we invest £6-7m of reserves in Fixed Deposits for 1-2 years @ 4.5% generating £270,000 - £315,000 p.a.in interest. Can this amount be used to cover the managing agent fees further reducing SC obligations for 1-2 years starting Sep 2023.	R&R update - The interest is paid into the reserve account as that is where the funds come from. Our finance director has advised that the interest should go to the reserve fund as this is a separate nominee account and is the one being placed on deposit.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
130	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	Can we replace concierge with security services who are also responsible for fire regs by 1st Sep 2023?	This is not a topic that the Board is actively considering. Other developments within Greenwich Peninsula have had security guards and they are not always considered as effective, as well as being much more expensive. We would still need to have at least one person in Concierge at all times for monitoring of alarms.
131	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	Pls share a governance structure with board composition, how it operates as well as a info on a transparent election process for new & current members to keep their seats?	A note has been issued from R&R which describes the process to be followed in the forthcoming elections to the Board. These are in accordance with the Articles of Association for GMVML.
132	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	Can we introduce block reps who are responsible for verifying works commissioned in their block scrutinising invoices on a weekly basis?	Please refer to FAQ on board and GMV structure. We have had block reps in the past as part of a GMVRA service charge sub-committee. This was active for a while before the volunteers for those blocks gradually reduced engagement. The board (and any future board) would welcome additional constructive help.
133	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	How can we commercialize/upgrade oval square so it contributes towards SC creating a more sustainable development?	GMVML is not a trading company and therefore does not engage in any profit-making enterprises. This is in line with other residential management companies. If a decision was taken to change this we would need to ensure any profit generated was commensurate with the cost of added reporting requirements, paying corporation tax, etc.
134	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	Can we organise an inventory check on the £123k spend on equipment for concierge from 2020-2022?	R&R update (please contact Greta for follow-up) - The total expenditure for 2019-2022 is £58,274 for office consumables, office equipment and IT purchase and maintenance. I am not sure where their figure of £123k came from so would need further clarity. Regarding inventory, see expenditure tab on supporting spreadsheet, this is mainly screens, chairs etc.
135	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	Can you explain why concierge wages spiked to almost £700k in 2020 during covid?	Staff costs were lower in 2020-21 than in 2019-20. In 2019 20 staff costs were almost £700k because VAT applied to staff costs for a full year for the first time.
136	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	Can you explain why ground maintenance (gardening fees) increased to £165k in 2021?	The cost over three years are as follows 2020 - £128,622, 2021 - £165,457 and 2022 - £129,253. The actual cost in 2021 spiked due to some additional planting that was approved by the board. Our standard contract covers ongoing maintenance but not periodic replanting.
137	Alamaro Lodge	Anthea	Can we conduct an analysis of the different leases with a spreadsheet to help leaseholders understand what services are included and/or excluded from their leases (24 hour concierge/CHP etc). This will help us understand scope we can to opt out and/or restructure?	This is not a topic that the Board is currently considering. The core schedule of services covering the Blocks and Estates (and car park, where appropriate) are in our individual leases.
138	Farnsworth Court	Carol Aylott	Can the Board explain the outrageous increase in standing charge that has been imposed by Switch2 retrospectively and with no warning only 6 months after an increase by GMVL? If not, why not? What was the Board's involvement with this decision? Will it challenge this on our behalf? There has been no response from GMVL or Switch2 to any complaints.	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2
139	Not specified	Christine A	Why are our Porters being tasked to deliver circulars etc from commercial entities such as Switch2? We're paying huge charges to S2 in particular so they should deliver they're own letters. As a consequence of using our site staff for this, their level of service to us is further diluted	Switch 2 during the initial phase of the upgrade had not been provided contact details for residents and owners by GMVL (the developer) or their previous agent for the heating SHW. They asked if we could provide this data but as they are not a supplier we appoint or are responsible for we were unable to share this under GDPR. We offered to deliver some mailshots they printed onsite so residents receive some updates and comms. They do now have contact details for leaseholders and should be sending electronic or physical letters directly.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
140	Not specified	Christine A	Why are over-tasked site staff used to fill in gaps for absences in buildings for which they're not responsible? Again, this dilutes our level of service and leaves them chasing their tails to keep up with the workload - not fair	R&R update (please contact Greta with any specifics) - If we could have more information on this I can then look into it. I assume the reference is made to where we had no cleaner for a little while and other staff covered those blocks (so still within GMV West). Usually we would look to get temporary cover which we have recently done instead of overstretching the existing staff and taking them away from their own work.
141	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why are service charges for Cottrell Court Flats (a low rise block without lifts) as high as for blocks with lifts?	Please review the FAQ on reserves and benchmarking.
142	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why the Board has never reviewed the CapEx expenditure plan that has been undertaken a long time ago and that is not relevant anymore and it's the main cause of our problems (e.g., it is based on 7-year cycle and extraordinary charges like £90k for windows redecoration, £90k for scaffolding that is not ever needed at least at the front of Cottrell Court while a cherry picker at a fraction of the price could be used at court side and only for the top two floors, £57k for 'emergency lighting', 13k to replace 50 square meters of carpet etc.)?	See FAQ on Reserves. For your block, and the majority of others, external works are currently planned on a 10-year, rather than 7-year cycle, following the round of consultations with Leaseholders in 2017. Access solutions for any works are considered on a case-by-case basis, depending on the nature of work, with the most cost effective solution identified for each work programme. This will be reviewed again at the next cycle of works for each to see what access method is best at that time. For all other works, where the cost is more than £250 for any individual leaseholder, then a formal consultation will be undertaken for Leaseholder to comment on the nature and necessity of the works as well as provide the outcome of the tenders. It is factually inaccurate to state that the Board has never reviewed the CapEx. This is reviewed on an annual basis. Once the cladding issues were identified, the Board made a decision to put a hold on all CapEx work unless it could not be delayed (e.g. water pump or fire alarm panel failures) until clarity had been gained on how this issue would be resolved. We now have clarity on how this will be concluded for the low rise flats and the Board committed, as part of the 2023/24 budget communication to further review the other CapEx items through the course of this year.
143	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why are we charged around £2000 for the external redecoration per window and the Board is not questioning this (£90k per redecoration + £90k for the scaffolding to redecorate around 100 windows at Cottrell Court Flats - this is from CapEx expenditure plan and also in practice), we are not replacing them each time but just 'splashing' a coat of gloss paint (please just don't not call this a maintenance)? We are all 'drowning' because we have to redecorate 4-5 windows and/or 20 square meters of rendering per flat every 10 years?! How much money realistically we need for this work? Should this be a problem even if we have to redecorate them every year? For example, Dave from Eddison Houses said via his WhatsApp message that he got a quote to replace wooden windows with aluminium windows at his house at a similar price per window?!	See FAQ on Reserves as well as response to item #144.
144	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why is so much money collected and kept aside for the eventual 'big ticket items' like windows replacement that may be needed in 20-30 years time or the possible 'roof collapse' that may happen in 100 years time or never? Don't the new buyers get a discount compared to a new build because of the possible unexpected costs that may arise in older buildings?	See FAQ on Reserves. The CapEx plan, published with the 2020/21 Service Charge pack (still available on the R&R Online portal) shows the nature and estimated value of expenditure your block (with the same available to every Leaseholder for their block). The actual replacement of windows is currently demised to individual leaseholders and not budgeted for within the CapEx. There is no specific allowance for 'roof collapse'. The principle for CapEx is that every Leaseholder pays a fair proportion of the planned works during their period of ownership. This is nothing about new buyers getting 'a discount'.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
145	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why is the Board so reluctant to reduce the reserve fund charges or pause the collection now while the CapEx review is ongoing, the reserve funds are healthy and the next redecoration cycle is years away (at least 5 but possibly 10 years), instead of waiting for another year or so? Is anybody going to give us back any possible overpayments?	See FAQ on Reserves.
146	Alamaro Lodge		Can you pls explain the £576 window cleaning services. If this relates to the entrance area, shouldn't this be done by our resident cleaner using basic equipment such. They can also be given proper equipment to get rid of the spider webs which occur so frequently and avoid unnecessary expenses. Here is a quick fix https://www.amazon.co.uk/IGADPole-Extension-Water-fed-Cobweb-Squeegee/dp/B09GNV8B17/ref=sr_1_12_sspa?keywords=window%2Bcleaning%2Bequipment&qid=1684145724&prefix=window%2Bclean%2Caps%2C92&sr=8-12-spons&sp_csd=d2lkZ2V0TmFtZT1zcF9tdGY&th=1	R&R update - Window cleaning is contracted out to an external company. The remit for this is to clean all the communal windows and some of these require cherry pickers. The common complaint raised by residents is that their buildings are not cleaned to a satisfactory standard - this is because we have 13 blocks and only 8 cleaners - their duties include hoovering, mopping, dusting, litter picking etc. We do not believe that adding an additional task of cleaning windows would be possible. See 'window cleaning' tab on supporting spreadsheet.
147	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Shouldn't the Board review the charges carefully before undertaking the internal redecoration work at cost of £850k (according to Shakti's WhatsApp message)? Couldn't this be a work for one/two handymen for a fraction of the price?	Yes, of course. No decoration work is undertaken before it is actually needed. Whilst there is a schedule for internal decorations, in practice a year before it is currently scheduled an inspection would be undertaken to assess whether it is needed or not. If not considered that it is needed it would be pushed back, rather than spending leaseholder money prematurely. If works were then progressed, for something like internal decorations, this would trigger a formal consultation process (as the cost is likely to exceed £250 per leaseholder). This would be the opportunity for leaseholders to provide opinions on the need for such work and suggest alternative contractors should they wish. At present, we don't have a team of internal decorators. This is, however, a topic that is on the Board agenda for consideration on whether it is feasible to expand the size and scope of the internal village team. Part of this consideration would be from a cost perspective but also from a resourcing, timing, quality and oversight perspective.
148	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why is nobody still fixing all these light sensors in halways and stair landings, with lights on 24/7/365 for years instead of being on 1 hour a day? Shouldn't this be a priority given the high electricity costs and the fact that we are already paying for on-site electricians?	There has been a programme across blocks to replace light fittings with LED ones and the Board were given updates on completion from R&R. R&R are currently validating the progress of this across the site. The Board have also asked them to specifically look at the sensors to see if additional PIR sensors need to be installed in areas that are on for extended periods when they shouldn't be (if this is cost effective to do). R&R have provided this additional detail - some of the blocks are wired differently - for example, Becquerel Court, all lights are wired together and if one sensor goes then all of them will stay on until full investigation can be carried out and the faulty sensor can be found. Another example is one of the cores in Farnsworth where there are no sensors so we would need to install these. It will be a lengthy process to change the way this was designed and quite costly however we are looking to get an opinion from an additional electrician and will get quotes for all the required works. For now, if we could ask the leaseholders to report the issues to the village manager, we can then get quotes for parts and get the onsite electrician to look into these.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
149	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why is MOAT allowed to replace the entry doors as they are pleased instead of replacing them like for like? It seems that MOAT only has one type of doors, that are usually only found on the council estates, and installs them everywhere internally or externally (e.g., Flat 3 at Cottrell Court, a couple of external entry doors at the Renaissance Walk). In addition, the doors at Cottrell Court remains unfinished for three years now?!	R&R response - We have inspected the doors mentioned and can confirm that flat 3 door looks to be the same as others it just needs to be repainted. The properties on Renaissance Walk (Metcalfe) seem to be the same apart from 3 Metcalfe and 4 Metcalfe. There is no one living in 3 Metcalfe and works seem to be needed to the property. Flat 4 doors are different colour (dark grey) than the rest, we have contacted MOAT to ask why this door is not in accordance with the rest. With regards to Cottrell Court and the doors being unfinished for three years - can we please be provided with more information so we can look into this. Please contact the village manager or Greta.
150	Cottrell Court Flats	Ljuban M	Why are the estate charges so high while all we have is only a concierge service that is used once/twice a year or even less often and yet there are 1000+ units in GMV West? Shouldn't we all benefit from the economies of scale?	Benchmarking FAQ
151			Can all tenders be shared on the portal for all big item expenditure relating to the development such as utilities, redecs, MA and leaseholder be given a 10 day window to contest or source a better alternative	For all major items there is a formal consultation process (Section 20 of the Landlords and Tenants act 1985). This is triggered where the costs of any specific works would cost any individual leaseholder more than £250, or if a long term contract (more than one year) was proposed. At present, there are no such long term contracts as all are at one year or less, which gives us flexibility to change, if required. As part of this consultation process, leaseholders have the opportunity to comment on the works required as well as the opportunity to propose contractors and see the outcome of the tenders.
152	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share the letter issued by R&R on Sep 10th, 2018, referenced in the Board meeting minutes	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019. Document requests also raised via R&R online which have been responded to.
153	Alamaro Lodge		Pls share proposed cost cuts / revised operational plan following a deep dive into the expenditure as evidenced by many on the group and how that will impact our Estate SC contributions going forward.	See FAQ on Reserves and Benchmarking
154	Edison Court Flats		Can we aim to have the revised CAPEX/OPEX by 1st October 2023 with extended life cycles for each development where possible	See FAQ on Reserves. Whilst work is in progress to review the CapEx throughout this year, we cannot commit that this work will be fully completed by October.
155	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	What have the board actively done to try reduce the Service Charge?	See FAQ on Reserves
156	Edison Court Flats	Jane	Are the board aware that these high levels of service charge, delays in fire safety measures, and thus the delay in fire safety certification has made the ownership of property in GMV unsaleable and stretching the finances for many. It is now a stress, a burden and not a joy anymore to live on this development.	The Board is very aware that the level of Service Charges are high and that over the last three years the issues with cladding/fire safety has stalled the market for properties in GMV West and apartments across the country. See separate note specifically on cladding. In relation to Edison flats, additional smoke/heat alarms are currently being installed. Once this has been completed for ALL properties in the low rise flats then we expect to be in a position to obtain sign-off which will facilitate an EWS1 form rating of B1, which would be adequate for both mortgage and conveyancing processes.
157	Edison Court Flats		when are getting the cladding works completed for the ews certificate	See FAQ on cladding
158	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share a letter issued by R&R to its clients setting out position cited in Nov 14 & 15th Board meeting	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019. Document requests also raised via R&R online which have been responded to.
159	Metcalfe Court	Dejan Miladinovic	Please share all R&R portal requests related to redecorations, which took place in 2019/2020 (Holly, Metcalfe)	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019. Document requests also raised via R&R online which have been responded to.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
160	Becquerel Court Low		can you please switch off or dim the courtyard lights at midnight? this is a massive waste of electricity and forces us to sleep with constant light pollution which several studies have shown to promote cancer. At least half of the lights should be removed altogether, it is complete overkill.	There has been a programme across blocks to replace light fittings with LED ones and the Board were given updates on completion from R&R. R&R are currently validating the progress of this across the site. The Board have also asked them to specifically look at the sensors to see if additional PIR sensors need to be installed in areas that are on for extended periods when they shouldn't be (if this is cost effective to do).
161	Becquerel Court Low		The block redecoration of a few years ago was poorly handled. A barely worn high quality thick carpet replaced with cheap and nasty carpet tiles that looked more like underlay - a downgrade in look and feel. In future can you give residents the opportunity to see what changes are being planned, particularly visible change like decor BEFORE agreeing the contract.	For all major items, including topics such as carpet replacements, there is a formal consultation process (Section 20 of the Landlords and Tenants act 1985). This is triggered where the costs of any specific works would cost any individual leaseholder more than £250, or if a long term contract (more than one year) was proposed. At present, there are no such long term contracts as all are at one year or less, which gives us flexibility to change, if required. As part of this consultation process, leaseholders have the opportunity to comment on the works required as well as the opportunity to propose contractors and see the outcome of the tenders. The carpets being replaced by carpet tiles was an example of a change in design to try and save leaseholder money. By using carpet tiles instead of carpets, there is an opportunity to replace individual damaged/worn elements individually rather than having to replace a whole floor or core at a time. This should then allow us to extend the overall replacement cycle for the blocks. Additionally, for particularly high traffic areas (such as main entrance or car park lobby areas) hard floor tiles are being used instead of carpets as these would be more longer lasting.
162	Becquerel Court Low		Is the service charge funding production and distribution of the glossy marketing brochure that pretends to be the village newsletter? This pointless brochure needs to be discontinued if it's paid for by us.	No. This is not financed or supported through Service Charge demands. This is for the developer to consider how they spend their marketing budget.
163	Becquerel Court High		Can we please stop paying greenmantle to run leaf blowers in the courtyard. The noise is obnoxious to both residents and wildlife and these instruments of torture seem to be employed on a constant basis for six months of the year	We will ask R&R to review this with the gardening contractor to see if alternatives are possible in a cost effective manner.
164	Becquerel Court High		Another on greenmantle - their fees are high yet their work seems unimaginative. No flowers planted, no planters or hanging baskets - just basic shrubbery. Would it be cheaper to employ a couple of dedicated gardeners - who might then feel better sense of ownership to actually invest in upkeep.	Our standard contract covers ongoing maintenance but not periodic replanting. Prior to 2020 we had developed an extensive replanting strategy. This was paused subsequent to the cladding issues where we suspended all non-essential spend. The first year of this replanting was still carried out in 2021 as the plants had already been purchased.
165	Maurer Court		if we dial down the concierge to a 9-9pm service how much staff costs would that save? could we vote for a new set of service levels given we are paying for nightshift work we dont need? i'd rather pay for security patrolling the grounds than someone sitting watching TV in an office where the stock answer to any query is 'i don't know, i'll leave a note for the day shift staff'	24x7 concierge services are mandated in our leases as an obligation. Any change to this would require approval from 1108 leaseholders individually. Whilst we recognise and acknowledge the cost concerns there are a number of residents who avail the key holding service if locked out at night and the concierge are also our first response point for any fire alarms before these are raised with the fire brigade. This is documented as part of our fire risk strategy.
166		Jane	Why are we still using R&R who in my experience charge very high fees, provide poor service and have terrible response times. Action :get quotes from other managing agents asap with a view to replacing R&R	Refer to the FAQ on benchmarking. It is a decision for the new board to determine when and if this is re-tendered.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
167		Jane	Why are staff costs so high. Who are we paying for, and again where is the transparency. Do we even need an overnight concierge with 3 full time staff. To me it is costly and unnecessary .	There is just one overnight Concierge staff, which is the minimum we can do as there is a lease requirement to provide a 24x7 Concierge service.. Other staff are day time Concierge, porters to clean the blocks, an office manager, maintenance manager and a maintenance operative (a post that is currently vacant and being recruited for).
168		Jane	Why is the reserve collection 60% of our service charge and continuing to rise annually ? Why are the cumulative reserve figures not declared for each block on a quarterly basis? We have no idea how much is in the pot and need more transparency. Why is it being collected at such high levels, what expenditure is planned ? Can collection be put on hold or reduced drastically until we know the scope of developer funded fire safety works . I went to a capex meeting a few years ago in which it was stated , reserves collection would increase for two years and then decrease - why has this not happened.	See FAQ on Reserves
169		Jane	Is any of the reserves fund being used for any other purposes other than cyclical maintenance as per terms of the lease . Given my understanding that the cycles have been pushed out to 20-25 years instead of 10 , we should be collecting half.	No. Detail of actual spend of the reserves are captured in the annual accounts published in September each year. See FAQ on Reserves
170		Jane	What checks are made on Aviva the freeholder providing the insurance. Is it put out to tender? is it competitive? , who gets the commission on placement ? . A few years ago I called Gallaghers to check the process, the insurance broker got evasive and then refused to discuss with me as a resident.	The Board has no visibility or oversight of the process to place the insurance, which is the responsibility of Aviva Ground Rent Limited (through their agents)
171		Jane	Is the board aware that the Aviva policy is not fit for purpose, as unlike 99% of standard block insurance policies it does not cover alternative accommodation for owner occupiers or lost rent for landlords In the event of fire etc. Should the block become uninhabitable , service charge , mortgage , plus alternative accommodation, during any lengthy refurb would all need to be paid Action :- Get insurance quotes from Aviva and from other companies with correct provision as above .	The freehold is owned by Aviva Investors and as per the terms of the lease the freeholder arranges insurance cover for the entire development - neither GMVML nor R&R have any remit on the cover unfortunately. From a review of the policy (which is available on R&R online) it does cover alternative accommodation for occupants. It does not cover loss of rent and this would typically need to be something a landlord seeks cover for separately if they feel it is needed.
172	Da Vinci Lodge	Kabeer Aslam	Is the board open to a hybrid model (as per the majority of other developments) of having lower annual reserve fund collection levels with potential additional future one off cash calls if absolutely required	See FAQ on Reserves. The view of the Board is that the cost of planned works should be distributed fairly throughout the period of ownership to avoid one-off invoices, as far as possible
173		Yuan Tian (A	Why are we paying 120% of the SC expenses for SC reserve fund?	See FAQ on Reserves
174		Yuan Tian (A	What's the outstanding value of the reserved fund?	See FAQ on Reserves
175		Yuan Tian (A	There's many wrongly issues tickets caused by the APNR cameras installed by the parking company, can we have them removed and get a tender for new company?	Yes, this is a topic that can be considered for progression by the Board.
176		Yuan Tian (A	SHW ignored my actual readings updates for 3-4 years now, and GMV sent me a final bill in Oct after switch2 replaced the meter with a high estimates, but the old meter final readings were not provided by the Switch2. Last time I emailed the actuals back in August, suggesting to work out an agreed amount from that, as their estimates are unreasonably high.	See FAQ on heating and Switch 2

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
177	Metcalfe Court	Farshad Safaei	How much reserves do we have for Metcalfe Court in the bank now, and what are the immediate expenditure for the upcoming year that merits getting further reserves before cladding fix is complete. As statement shows reserves for external wall repair and maintenance mostly.	See FAQ on Reserves
178	Metcalfe Court	Farshad Safaei	Also is it prudent to keep high reserves at inflationary time that erodes our reserves when not needed?	See FAQ on Reserves
179	Edison Court Flats	Wendy Durrant	How will decisions made about high rise buildings effect the low rise buildings E.g. if high rise change the exterior look, (brick) will low rise have to follow suit, but at our expense not paid by the developer.	Low rise will not be impacted by any decisions on high rise. Even for the high rise, any works will need to look visually very similar, as required by Greenwich Planning Department. No major changes to visual appearance of low rise is envisaged either.
180	Metcalfe Court	Shashank Ja	What percentage of the total SC goes towards reserve charge per block, and overall for estate ? Assuming that reserves are not collected, what would the SC be ? (call it the "base SC") Please provide details for the reserves available per block and the planned capex expenditure per block	See FAQ on Reserves and Benchmarking
181	Metcalfe Court	Shashank Ja	How does our base SC compare to other developments in London and in North Greenwich? Is there any benchmarking exercise? How does our base SC compare to the base SC of new GMV buildings?	See FAQ on Benchmarking
182	Metcalfe Court	Shashank Ja	Lastly, assuming board agrees that base SC is way out of normal, what are the potential steps being considered in the short term, and also in the longer term ?	See FAQ on Reserves, Cladding and Benchmarking
183	New Becquerel Court	Nicola Jayne Jordan	Why does R & R service charge not show the decline in the economy of affordability? Is the service charge making the property a bad deal for a mortgage / ability to pay bills / buy to let mortgage / investment?	The Service Charge demands are for the costs incurred to maintain our buildings and communal areas. Whilst we all feel the pressures of the adverse economic cycle, this doesn't not result in our suppliers lowering their costs for us.
184	New Becquerel Court	Nicola Jayne Jordan	R & R - costs high does it reflect level of price? Why is the gardening bad?	See FAQ on Benchmarking
185	New Becquerel Court	Nicola Jayne Jordan	Bus stop - oval square is that bus stop in the best place? Does it create a mess for New Becquerel? Is it affecting New Becquerel's value to sell & quality of life for residents?	This is a matter for Transport for London. GMVML have no control but we did make representations at the time the stop was moved from the central reservation to try to ensure the stop caused as little disruption to residents as possible.
186	New Becquerel Court	Nicola Jayne Jordan	Crime - is there any evidence of crime on the cctv pointing towards New Becquerel? A letter was sent from Greta about drug dealers can she see we have a problem?	Not that we are aware specific to this block.
187	New Becquerel Court	Nicola Jayne Jordan	Interior painting & carpets wear & tear do we really need to change it? How about not just Hoover but cleaning it properly?	See FAQ on Reserves. Internal decorations (painting, decorating, carpet replacement) will only be undertaken when they are really required. Deep cleans of all buildings are currently in progress, with enhanced supervision and oversight deployed to ensure that day-to-day cleaning standards are maintained.
188	New Becquerel Court	Nicola Jayne Jordan	Switch 2 is their a problem with invoice software as bills incorrect?	See FAQ on Heating and Switch 2

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
189	Maurer Court	C.M ADAMSON	Why does the Board not ensure that the Secretary posts Board Meeting Minutes in a timely manner? Would they please do so to ensure more transparency.	The minutes of the Board meeting are prepared and presented to the next Board meeting for review and approval. The minutes should be posted shortly after they have been approved at the next Board meeting. We acknowledge that some minutes have not then been posted in a timely manner, which we commit to improving. We are also aware of an issue where some of the online postings had inadvertently been set to expire, rather than them remaining available. We understand that this issue has now been resolved.
190	Maurer Court	C.M ADAMSON	The last set of Board minutes to be posted to the portal were posted on 2 November 2022 and pertained to the meeting held on 22 May 2022. The March 2022 minutes have not been posted and none have been posted since. We therefore have no visibility of the Board discussions since May 2022. For example, having no visibility of discussions after May 22, we have no idea as to the further discussions and therefore as to the potential implications (cost and safety measures ...) of the Building Safety Act 2022 which came into force in January 2023.	The minutes of the Board meeting are prepared and presented to the next Board meeting for review and approval. The minutes should be posted shortly after they have been approved at the next Board meeting. We acknowledge that some minutes have not then been posted in a timely manner, which we commit to improving. We are also aware of an issue where some of the online postings had inadvertently been set to expire, rather than them remaining available. We understand that this issue has now been resolved.
191	Maurer Court	C.M ADAMSON	Given our current operating model, the imposition by HMG in 2018 of VAT on staff costs resulted in an unavoidable and substantial increase to Service Charges. Has the Board considered and potentially examined and costed changing that operating model with a view to perhaps contracting out the cleaning and maintenance functions, or would it please do so? A tender process would be run and a contract price agreed for the term of the contract (with provision for review in accordance for example with the CPR). Current staff would, if they wished, be TUPE to the successful provider. The contractor would provide supervision, training and modern equipment and be held to account. Costs would thus be predictable for the contract term.	Contract payments are subject to VAT in the same way as the charge on the costs of staff employed by the managing agent. Both options have advantages and disadvantages depending on the circumstances and the task undertaken. There is also pressure to bring work in-house rather than contract it out
192	Maurer Court	Pat McKenzie	Are the board aware that the SC at current levels has made properties unsaleable and is forcing distressed sales. And if so, in as simple as possible terms, what action do they plan to take to improve this situation and bring the SC to a level that is comparable to the London average?	See FAQ on Reserves, cladding and benchmarking
193	Farnsworth Court	Peter Spinks	What is the formal process for the approval of expenditure and modifications to service charge? And what level of independent audit and assurance is applied to this in order to ensure value for spend and protect leaseholder interests? [further detail on scope of audit / assurance process, including how leaseholders gain access would be appreciated]	The Board is responsible for reviewing and setting the budget each year (both Service Charge and Reserves). This is done through review of historic expenditure as well as considering known changes for the following year. This is for the budget setting process, but the actual spend is not likely to be exactly the same over the course of the year. The actuals are subject to independent audit each year as part of the process to prepare and sign-off the annual accounts, which are published in September each year. For the Reserves element of the budget setting see the Reserves FAQ.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
194	Maurer Court	C.M ADAMSON	I refer to the GMVML Memorandum of Association of 24 March 2000, Article 8 Clauses (a) to (f) entitled 'General Meetings and Resolutions' This MoA provides for both Annual General Meetings and Extraordinary General Meetings - the latter for the passing of any Special Resolutions. In 6.5 years as a Shareholder I have never received a Calling Notice or an Agenda for an AGM. Why is this so? When was the last AGM actually held? When does the Board intend holding an AGM? The only meetings I recall were those (very welcome) meetings to discuss the cladding issues which would be defined by the MoA as Extraordinary General Meetings. I would have expected an annual meeting for Shareholders (having been presented with Accounts and Budget) to be accorded the ability to engage, comment and question. An AGM is all about accountability to Shareholders for expenditure and decisions made.	The provisions in the Articles referred to in the question were removed after the 2006 Companies Act ended the requirement for a private company such as GMVML to hold an Annual General Meeting (and abolished the terms "Annual General Meeting" and "Extraordinary General Meeting"). The last General Meeting of GMVML was on 2 November 2017. Please refer to FAQ on board communications. The current Articles of Association were adopted at the 2 November 2017 General Meeting
195	Maurer Court	C.M ADAMSON	In order to mitigate energy costs, what plans does the Board have to invest in newer technology than we currently have? Such investment is, I'm told, recouped in about 3 years. e.g. 1. Convert the whole village to LED lighting (rather than a bulb here and there). Install light sensors on external lights rather than old tech manual timers so we are not lighting up and unnecessarily consuming electricity in broad daylight as is often the case now until someone nags VM to get the timers altered - an operation that also costs in manpower terms as apparently an electrician has to run around and alter the switches individually. Any other measures. Sustainable village or not?	Converting lights to LED is already in progress. Other options will be considered. There are other responses here that go into more details on the practical challenges and cost on timers / sensors for some blocks and car parks.
196			If night shift concierge costs £1,000 per flat (random number example) then we should consider removing that service. Main thing is the Operational costs cannot be justified as many leaseholders already pointed out.	Some services, such as a 24x7 Concierge are defined by the provisions in the lease. This overnight Concierge service has been reduced down to one person in order to reduce costs. See FAQ Benchmarking.
197	Cottrell Court Flats	Vinayak	Even with minimal interest rate between 0.1-1 in 2021, there should be entry of interest earned. It's strange our y/w statements don't include interest earned	Interest is shown in the accounts when it is paid. Interest was accruing during 2020 but was not paid until the following year.
198			why all 7 members like to continue and keep the status quo. Some of you have been in your positions for almost a decade. and why should all 7 continue.	See FAQ on Board and GMV Structure
199	Becquerel Court High	Santhosh Narayana	Leaseholder's survey shows that over 90% of leaseholders are unhappy with how GMV West is managed right now. Will you take responsibility for this, step down as a Board, and if you want, run for re-election?"	See FAQ on Board and GMV Structure

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
200	Becquerel Court High	Naveen	Can you give us details on how first GMV Director and subsequent GMV Directors were appointed. Are you able to provide us with legal documentation in relation to appointment of Directors.	See FAQ on Board and GMV Structure
201	Becquerel Court High	Naveen	Who was responsible for setting up lease-holders legal framework. Have any changes been made to leaseholder agreement since first implementations? If so, what changes and what process was followed.	See FAQ on Board and GMV Structure. The overall structure was defined within the various leases, which were first prepared by the developers as part of construction of the village.
202	Becquerel Court High	Naveen	Can you respond to Hearsay that only 3 out of 7 directors are actively involved in decision-making. Can you please name them? The remaining 4 directors, if not actively involved, would they like to give up their position to more capable?	See FAQ on Board and GMV Structure. The board believes in collective responsibility and will not comment on individual directors past or present. As an election has been called each current director needs to decide if they want to stand to serve on the board for the next 4 years and present their aims for what they will focus on.
203		Preeti	Why do we contract out so any services rather than dealing with them as and when needed or directly employing? The contracts do not seem to be giving us value for money and no one is monitoring whether the contractual obligations are being undertaken	The Managing Agent, currently R&R, is engaged to manage the contractors onsite to ensure that any works are completed to an appropriate standard and quotes should be obtained to ensure that they are competitive. Depending on the nature of the task will define whether the task is outsourced or managed in-house. Generally, where the scale of work is not sufficient for multi members of staff, the works are outsourced. Otherwise we would have no resilience in the event of unplanned leave or holidays. The Board will, however, consider whether some elements could be managed in-house in a cost-effective manner.
204	Farnsworth Court	Ann	After years of being stuck in the cladding fiasco many leaseholders will be desperate to sell due to changing circumstances (having to move due to work, outgrowing flats because of having children, changing financial circumstances etc). The thought of having the cladding fixed only to be stuck unable to sell because of high service charges is very concerning for many. We already know that many owners will need to take a massive cut when selling their flats due to the number that will come on the market at the same time. What is the board going to do to support owners that unfortunately need to sell their flats at the earliest possible opportunity?	The Board cannot and should not be involved in any specific conveyancing issues. The Board does, however, recognise that many Leaseholders are unable to sell their properties in the absence of the required sign-offs in relation to the External Wall Systems (cladding). See FAQ for Cladding.
205	Metcalfe Court	Olimkhon	One thing others may have noted from experience is that refurbishment work claim after accidents in individual flat (water leak in my case) usually is much higher than what it would cost if one were to get external person to do it, higher by several times. Although it is approved by insurer somehow, it does not help with insurance repricing if maintenance guys are overcharging the insurer for such work.	In the event of an insurance claim, the insurers decide whether they appoint a loss adjuster or not. They will also review invoices against a schedule of what they consider as reasonable costs, before they consider to approve the claim or not. Leaseholders are free to (and will be encouraged) to obtain quotations from their preferred contractors, where desired. The insurer is likely to approve the lower of any quotes provided.
206		Sudhanshu	From the feedback provided by the directors, it seems like quite a challenging job. So, are there any governing policies or guidelines that aid the directors in their decision making? For e.g when a critical event like deciding to increase the charge by c.25% happens, shouldn't the decision be put to vote to the leaseholders or at least shouldn't the leaseholders be made aware of the increase rather than them coming to know about it via the actual bills.	Detailed review of budget is completed each year. This year in particular, the increases were driven by extremely high increases in electricity costs, which is driven by the commodities market. Voting would not be appropriate - no-one would ever vote for an increase in electricity costs, but it is one of the lines, where we do not have a choice on whether to pay it or not. Formal consultations are required where any specific works are planned which would cost any individual leaseholder £250 or more, through the 'Section 20' process.
207		Sudhanshu	If the decision is taken by the Board to disagree with the pricing of the charges what happens then? Is that communicated to R&R and they just comply. I just want to understand if something similar was done during the current price hike and if the push back from R&R was so great that the board just yielded to their demands.	See FAQ on Board and GMV Structure. R&R are appointed by the board and report to us. If there is feedback from them we will consider it but own the ultimate decision. The note accompanying service charges details the reasons for the increase this year. A large element of it was down to electricity which is now expected to fall back by ~70%.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
208		Sudhanshu	The reserve fund - how does it compare against the other building societies /developments across London. Do other building societies have something similar? When benchmarked against the charges paid by comparable London developments, if we are on the higher side(which we all know by now, we are) what can be done to correct the pricing of our current charge without affecting the future cladding works?	See FAQ on Reserves and Benchmarking.
209		Sudhanshu	I understand the reserve funds are more like contingent funds. And like me, many would have already paid many thousands of pounds into this fund. But not all of those funds are used to provide tangible services/benefits or address an emergency during the period we own the flat/s. So if we sell our flat is there a option to claim back a percentage of the reserve funds contribution?	See FAQ on Reserves and Benchmarking. No, there is no intention that anyone selling will 'claim back' any reserves contributions.
210		Sudhanshu	Also about electing a new board - whether the current board decides to voluntarily resign or not, with new and challenging issues that have cropped up in recent times, we need a fresh set of minds. The current board should still be allowed to stand in the election as we need their experience (not necessarily their knowledge)	See FAQ on Board and GMV Structure.
211		Sudhanshu	There are many leaseholders who have decided to withhold their payments - either entirely or just the incremental charges. Has the Board made R&R aware of this? Dealing with rising charges is one thing but getting penalised by an enormous fine simply for raising genuinely valid concerns/disputes against the increments is not justifiable. How is the Board ensuring that such leaseholders are protected against such fines, while we are still discussing this?	The Board routinely monitors the collection of Service Charge monies and the level of over dues. In the event that anyone has challenges with making the payments on time, it is encouraged to discuss specific individual circumstances with R&R. Whilst they may be able to agree an alternative payment plan, they will not be able to agree to waive payments as all leaseholders need to pay their proportional share. Where cases are referred to solicitors R&R will charge £180 (there is no charge for the first two reminders). Bretherton's (the legal firm) will then take charges for any actions they also take to collect the outstanding amount. It is not part of the managing agent fee as it wouldn't be rechargeable to all leaseholders and is a specific cost for chasing delayed payments.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
212			Why have the service charges been increased by 30-40% when there is clearly no evidence of a need for it and reserves are healthy? Why didn't you think it was important to consult on such a big change? Did you conduct any survey or analysis to understand if these increases were at all affordable, particularly in the current cost of living crisis? Do you not realise these increases are making properties unsalable or do you not care because no one from the board intends to sell their properties? Especially given a few own multiple and have sat on the board for a long time? Do you appreciate the mental health implications of what you have done? Why won't you acknowledge or help leaseholders that are unable to pay, have had sales fallen through, have had unreasonable fees imposed upon them? Why do you allow the current situation to go on and ignore pleas for help especially when you've been directly approached by a number of leaseholders on the injustice they've suffered? Following the significant discontent, do you intend significantly slash, at least half, the service charges (incl cutting off reserve collection)? If not, why? Do you intend to sell your property(s) in the next 5 years?	See FAQ on Reserves and Benchmarking.
213			Why do you continue to turn a blind eye to R&R's incompetence?	Please provide more specific details.
214			Why haven't last years minutes been fully published yet despite hiring a consultant that takes minutes?	Minutes are available on R&R online portal. There was an issue where some meeting minutes had been set with an expiry date, instead of being continually visible. This should now be resolved.
215			Why are you on the board?	See FAQ Board Structure - Board elections to take place 6 July.
216			Why is R&R's contract 364 days long? Why are you ok with this?	It is standard practice for contracts to be up to a year, which enables options for tenders to be terminated, if required, rather than long term contracts which restrict this ability for both sides. Unless there was a specific service or price advantage, it is unlikely that a contract greater than a year would be considered.
217			Where do the proceeds or donations from filming go? What have they been used for? E.g. BBC's hard sun	R&R update - We don't believe R&R or GMVML ever received any funding for this. If it related to a single property this is a matter for the leaseholder involved.
218	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Can Board share the unredacted managing agent benchmarking note/advice?	No, as the advice was provided on the basis that it was confidential to the Board. But see [Bench marking note].
219	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Please share any previous advices on tendering MA contract received from consultants in the past 10 years?	No, as the advice was provided on the basis that it was confidential to the Board. But see [Bench marking note].
220	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Did the Board consider input from leassholders ahead of 2023/2024 budget? If so, what are the reasons for not engaging?	Please refer to FAQ on board communications.
221	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Has the Board considered any brokers other than R&R for electricity procurement in the past 3 years ? If so, what was the decision process?	Effective duplicate of one of your other queries

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
222	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	When did GMVML enter into a contract (instruct, sign, contract start date) with PJ Harte on external redecorations for Metcalfe & Holly	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019
223	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	How many flats are rented vs owner occupier ? They can probably estimate based on sub-let filings or correspondence addresses	Approx 33% owner occupied and 67% tenanted (which includes 182 MOAT properties)
224	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Can board share the Notice of Intention dated Nov 16th, 2018	See FAQ - External Redecs 2019
225	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Can board share Minutes of Board meeting from Jan 2019 and any other Board meeting between Jan and May 2019	All Board minutes are published on the R&R online portal for you to view.
226	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Board to share any report from R&R on the electricity procurement	Please see FAQ on electricity.
227	Metcalfe Court	Dejan	Board to share Indicative Tariff options presented by Switch 2 and GMVL	We suggest you reach to the author of any information you believe exists.
228		David	You raised the point about 2016 and 2023 tender discussion/benchmarking. I'm asking for you to provide info. It shouldn't be contentious. I just know that no adviser would recommend to not tender such an important contract routinely	No, as the advice was provided on the basis that it was confidential to the Board. But see [Bench marking note].
229	Newton Lodge	Eric Law	We all own flats in GMV, so what makes the Directors more powerful than the others Leaseholder? Do directors own 51% of GMVML?	The Directors have no higher ownership than any other individual leaseholder. See FAQ GMVML Board Structure
230	Becquerel Court High	Alex	We wanted to know about what plans are in place to identify the Principal Accountable Person and if registration with the new Building Safety Regulator is required, which we understand will be the case if the building is over 18 meters in height or at least 7 storeys, with Safety Case Reports to then be issued. This follows legislation passed under the Building Safety Act 2022.	R&Rs health and safety team have issued a letter (18 April 2023) to GMVML asking us to confirm who the principal accountable person will be for GMV West. R&R will need confirmation on whether GMVML will register the buildings ourselves or will instruct R&R (this is at an additional cost). This is still under consideration by the board.
231	Holly Court	Andrew Loong	I read the email regarding planned service charge reductions for 2023/2024. I am concerned that the future plans are then to increase the service charge for 2024/2025 to an even higher amount of what we are currently paying as a result of this. Please confirm if this is the case, as it would be counterproductive and unfair to all us leaseholders to do so.	Your concern is noted. The Board advised a temporary reduction in the reserves collection for the remainder of this year. There are a number of elements of expenditure that are currently being review, with a view to reducing the overall costs that need to be provisioned for in each of the blocks, such as lifts and the potential for changing the external decoration cycles, particularly where the original developer is likely to be remediating the external wall system (cladding) of your block. Additionally, one of the key drivers to the increase in Service Charges this year was the price of the communal electricity, driven by external market factors. The tender for the next year (from October 2023) is currently in progress and there is indication that the costs will be much lower, thereby reducing the immediate pressure on budgets for next year.
232	Newton Lodge	Geraldine	The carpets that were fitted in Newton Lodge which I addressed with Bill as being completely unsuitable for wear and tear purposes as they cannot be cleaned by the cleaner. In order to clean these it requires bleach and water to each strip which is not being done. Bill's response was the reason these were fitted was that they were easily replaced in sections and that when he requested the tenants to come and view choice prior to being fitted, very few people came forth therefore these were just replaced.	R&R update - The section 20 consultation process for carpet replacement and internal redecorations was carried out late 2018 however there were no observations received from Newton Lodge residents. The notices advised the residents that they should visit the site to review the specification. The reason that this type of carpet was chosen is because it will be easier to replace sections should we need to instead of having to replace the whole carpet. Also, we do not use bleach on site and the cleaners would not be able to deep clean these or any other carpets where bleach needs to be used. We use eco friendly products on site. The spec for the carpet was approved by the board of GMVML. If a formal representation had been made by a resident as part of the section 20 process this would have been considered.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
233	Newton Lodge	Geraldine	The Reserve Funding for Newton Lodge is under query as well because we have not even had the exterior works being done and queried this at a meeting some years back with Bill and he advised that this was not required then.	See FAQ for Reserves. In relation of timing for external works for Newton, all major expenditure has been paused, pending the outcome of the cladding issues. Once the scope of the work paid for by the Developer is defined, the CapEx for your block can be reviewed and adjusted, as required.
234	Newton Lodge	Geraldine	Confirmation that all the windows at Newton Lodge are aluminium.	No, not aluminium. Most blocks (except Alamaro, Faraday and Maurer) have external wooden window frames. Specifically for Newton some of the windows in the pods at the top appear to be aluminium the rest are wooden windows from a company called Rationale.
235	Faraday Lodge	Laurent	There has been a lot of discussion in the past about the financing of the cladding replacement but not much about what sort of new cladding will replace the old one. Personally I would very much like the new cladding to match the appearance of the old wooden one. There are some very good imitation of wood made of composite material. This would keep the character of our building. Would you be so kind as to send me any information about the type of cladding we can expect?	Decisions on the exact material to be used will form part of the planning and scoping of the remediation project which will happen over the coming months. It is, however, clear from discussions the Board have had with the planning team at Greenwich council, is that they will insist on materials that visually appear to be as close the existing materials as possible. Once defined, the plans for the specific materials will be public information as part of the planning process and we would expect Leaseholder engagement meetings with the developer as they execute the remediation programme.
236	Kilby Court	KC	In the past 5 years (pre 2023 SC hike), did the board of directors look into any of the SC increase and determined any areas of savings? If yes, what were the areas and saving per item/per year? (Any other actions that the board has done in the past years that resulted in actual saving for the leaseholders is welcome but please note the item, amount of saving, and the year of action.)	Please refer to the FAQs on benchmarking and reserves. The one on reserves in particular will highlight the recent work done on lifts which effects a number of blocks. For your block specifically the review of external maintenance cycles may have a beneficial impact.
237	Kilby Court	KC	Excluding the lack of transparency and communication, what was the top three mistakes the board of directors has make in resulting the SC in GMV twice as the average London rate?	This is for others to consider and opine. See FAQ Benchmarking for factual comparisons
238	Kilby Court	KC	Does the board of directors think a forensic accountant at this stage to identify potential wastage of SC and/or corruption between village staff and hired contractors a good idea, and why?	With it being an active investigation it isn't possible to comment fully on this. As a principle any potential wastage and restitution should be established independently (at R&R cost). If elements of the investigation identify corruption, fraud or any criminal matters these should be referred to the police for further review and action.
239	Kilby Court	KC	What is the due diligence process in hiring contractors in general? How do you identify and determine nepotism, and/or favouritism, and/or corruption?	R&R as our appointed managing agents are responsible for ensuring all contractors onsite and centrally are reviewed in line with the due diligence process - this should include but not limited to - financial reviews, background checks, commercial value, undisclosed interests, etc. We would expect this when onboarding a new contractor and further detailed reviews if any substantial concerns are raised.

Query Number	Block	Name	Query	Board Response
240	Kilby Court	KC	When hiring contractors, what is the process on identifying any undisclosed relationships and connections to existing R&R employers and/or board of directors?	R&R as our appointed managing agents are responsible for ensuring all contractors onsite and centrally are reviewed in line with the due diligence process - this should include but not limited to - financial reviews, background checks, commercial value, undisclosed interests, etc. We would expect this when onboarding a new contractor and further detailed reviews if any substantial concerns are raised. Specifically for the board we are not typically involved in hiring contractors as this is what we hire a managing agent for. The board do maintain a register of interests that is updated at least annually and is not aware of any relationships between directors and any contractors that have provide services to GMV West either currently or in the past.
241	Kilby Court	KC	What is the immediate cause of actions if any corruption found between existing staff and contractors?	I assume you mean course of action. If any corruption or fraud is identified it would trigger a HR investigation with sanction up to and including dismissal. In addition, if the corruption constitutes any criminal matters these should be referred to the police for further review and action.
242	Kilby Court	KC	Who is ultimately responsible for evaluating the quality and effectiveness of the contractors, and what could've been done better to ensure leaseholders receive the value of service of what they are paying for?	Moral responsibility ultimately sits with the board of directors. R&R as our managing agent are specifically contracted to provide this service. This includes identifying contractors, running tender, evaluating the quality of work and service. Where gaps have been identified in this they will be held to account for financial restitution by the current and I assume any future board.
243	Kilby Court	KC	As one of the board members once stated, the board of directors only review and approve any job quotations that's over £2000. (1) Has the board rejected any quotations simply because it's too pricy? If yes please give details, if no, why? (2) does the board of directors review the yearly jobs and the total amount of invoices from contractors? Raising this because there are several jobs quoted just under £2k repeatedly.	The Board do not routinely approve any invoices, regardless of value. The review and approval of invoices is the role of the managing agent, currently R&R. For high value expenditure, R&R should seek approval from the Board in advance of it being commissioned. All expenditure from the reserves is approved by the Board, but R&R are paid to manage the development and contractors on a day-to-day basis, which should ensure that works are done to the appropriate standards and that quotations are obtained in advance to ensure competitive pricing.
244	Kilby Court	KC	Will there be a full review of currently approved contractors in 2023?	A review of key contractors is in progress
245	Kilby Court	KC	Specifically for Kilby Apartments, where there's no lifts or cladding remediation, when the current 84p electricity contract ends in Oct 2023, will there be an immediate reduction in thre service charge demand for Q4 2023 and going forward?	Once the electricity costs are known from Q4 onwards, if there is a material difference, the Board will consider whether any interim adjustments to the Service Charge demands would be appropriate from Q4 2023.
246	Farnsworth Court	Soumya	Similarly, if we have to electrify our car park what is the plan?	This has been a long standing agenda topic for the board. Our goal is to ensure it isn't a piecemeal upgrade but allows for a reasonable percentage of the car park to be upgraded given all internal combustion sales will stop in 2030. The upgrade will potentially require a new energy sub station and significant costs. There is now new government funding for apartment complexes to fund these works so we have begun evaluating it. There are also items to review on if leases need to be updated (we have a right to park but not allocated spaces), how initial works would be paid for (i.e. early adopters or all users), how ongoing charges for electricity will be recovered, etc.

